

Leah Ettensohn

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EDUCATION

University of California San Diego (UCSD), La Jolla, CA Aug 2022 - Expected May 2028
Ph.D. in Experimental Psychology, Cognitive Neuroscience Concentration GPA: 4.00/4.00
Jerri-Ann and Gary E. Jacobs Fellow

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA Aug 2016 - May 2020
B.S. Cognitive Psychology, *Phi Beta Kappa* GPA: 3.97/4.00
Minor in Cognitive Neuroscience & in Photography
Honors Thesis: Decoupling VWFA Lateralization & Hemispheric Spatial Frequency Tuning

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Ph.D. Candidate, UCSD

Perception and Cognition Lab, Dr. John Serences Aug 2022 - Present

- Investigate the cognitive and neural mechanisms of cross-modal working memory using neuroimaging, psychophysics, and computational modeling
- Designed and implemented a dedicated audiovisual and visuo-haptic experimental testing suite to enable multimodal research
- Mentor and train junior graduate students and undergraduate researchers

Post-Baccalaureate Fellow, National Institutes of Health May 2020 - June 2022

Laboratory of Brain and Cognition, Dr. Leslie Ungerleider & Dr. Chris Baker

- Investigated the cognitive and cortical mechanisms of vision for action perception using neuroimaging and web-based, crowd-sourced studies
- Managed resources and promoted efficient data sharing for collaborative research projects

Undergraduate Researcher, Carnegie Mellon University Sep 2018 - Aug 2020

Behrmann Lab, Dr. Marlene Behrmann

- Conducted a university-funded honors thesis investigating VWFA lateralization and hemispheric spatial frequency tuning
- Co-authored a study examining visual plasticity in epileptic patients following cortical resections

Summer Undergraduate Researcher, Carnegie Mellon University May 2018 - Sep 2018

Center for Cognitive Brain Imaging, Dr. Marcel Just

- Programmed psychophysical experiments and presented comprehensive literature reviews

AWARDS

Jerri-Ann and Gary E. Jacobs Endowed Fellowship, *University of California San Diego (2022-present)*

Outstanding Poster Award, *National Institutes of Mental Health (2021)*

Postbaccalaureate Intramural Research Training Award, *National Institutes of Health (2020-2022)*

Anderson Senior Leadership Award, *Carnegie Mellon University (2020)*

Phi Beta Kappa Honors Society (2019)

Dietrich Honors Research Fellowship, *Carnegie Mellon University (2019)*

Phi Kappa Phi Honors Society (2018)

Psi Chi Honors Society (2017)

High Honors Dean's List, *Carnegie Mellon University (2016-2020)*

SCHOLARSHIP

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Granovetter M., Roberts S., **Ettensohn L.**, Behrmann M. (2022). With childhood hemispherectomy, one hemisphere can support – but is suboptimal for – word and face recognition. Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences.

Presentations

Ettensohn, L. J., Sunyoung, P., & Serences J. T. (2025). Cross-modal recruitment of sensorimotor cortices during a purely visual working memory task. Poster presented at the Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting.

Ettensohn, L. J., Sunyoung, P., & Serences J. T. (2024). Cross recruitment of haptic representations during a visual working memory task. Poster presented at the Vision Sciences Society Annual Meeting.

Ettensohn L., Woodard K., Ungerleider L., Baker C., & Vaziri Pashkam M. (2021). Investigating the mental representation of observed grasp movements through similarity judgements. Poster presented at the Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting.

Ettensohn L., Woodard K., Ungerleider L., Baker C., Vaziri Pashkam M., (2021). Exploring the mental representation of observed grasp movements based on similarity judgements. Poster presented at the Vision Sciences Society Annual Meeting.

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Taste of Science, Outreach Volunteer	Feb 2026 - Present
Organize STEM event in the San Diego community, making science more accessible to everyone	
UCSD Neuro Outreach, Volunteer	Dec 2025 - Present
Visit classrooms to foster a curiosity for neuroscience with young students in greater San Diego	
UCSD Psychology Colloquium Committee, Student Representative	Aug 2022 - Present
Promote the speaker series, organize speaker schedules, & act as liaison for visiting speakers at UCSD	
Biology Undergraduate and Masters Mentorship Program, Graduate Mentor	July 2023 - Sep 2024
Provide academic mentorship to historically underserved biology undergraduate & master's students	
Wilkins School Community Center, Event Coordinator Volunteer	Jan 2015 - May 2022
Organized community art exhibits & an annual "Eco-Festival" for climate education	
Carnegie Climate Committee, Student Researcher	Aug 2019 - Jan 2020
Work with the department to survey & analyze students' quality of life	
Kappa Kappa Gamma & Reading is Fundamental, Service Chair	July 2018 - Jan 2019
Organized volunteer events to provide reading materials to children in need	

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

Lead lectures, conduct exam review sessions, design exams, hold one-on-one office hours, grade assignments

Memory and the Law, Dr. John Wixted, UCSD (Winter 2026)

Evolution and Human Nature, Dr. Robert Steiner, UCSD (Summer 2025)

Psychology of Parenting, Dr. Dave Barner, UCSD (Spring 2025)

Memory and Amnesia, Dr. John Wixted, UCSD (Spring 2024)

Behavioral Modification, Dr. Katharine Lacefield, UCSD (Fall 2023 & Winter 2024)

Cognitive Psychology, Dr. Timothy Brady, UCSD (Winter 2022)

Social Psychology, Dr. Chante Cox-Boyd, CMU (Fall 2018)

SKILLS

Programming: MATLAB; Python; R-Studio Suite; Web programming (HTML, CSS, Java)

Experimental Tools: fMRI design, data collection & analysis; Polhemus Liberty motion tracking; Eyelink

Other: MTurk; Qualtrics; Adobe Creative Suite; Computer-Aided Design (CAD); 3D printing

STUDENTS SUPERVISED

Organize weekly journal club meetings, advise students' projects, and mentor graduate school applications

Hannah Harris (post-baccalaureate researcher, UCSD)

Sophia Kistler (undergraduate researcher, UCSD)

Anika Bhandari (undergraduate researcher, UCSD)

Roshni Nischal (research assistant, Behrmann Lab)